

Hatching out

Newly hatched salmon are called alevin. They are tiny—just 1 inch (2.5 cm) long. They have a large yolk sac, which they feed on.



Young fish

After a few weeks, the baby salmon, called fry, are already good swimmers. They leave the stream where they were born and swim into lakes to find food. They mostly eat insects, and some plankton.



Changing color

By the time they are two years old, the young salmon, called smolt, have changed color and are now silver with red tails. They swim downriver into an estuary, where they adapt to salty water before swimming out to sea.



Eggs

The female makes a nest in the gravel at the bottom of a shallow stream and lays 50–200 eggs. The male dies after he fertilizes the eggs, and the female dies soon after. The eggs remain in the nest for 32–42 days.

